A Ghost, A Beast, A Child

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/43182066.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Major Character Death

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

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Alternate Universe - Pre-Canon, Catra living in the Whispering Woods, Drabble, Ghost Stories, Angst, Hurt No Comfort, No editors we die with courage, Narrative fun with tenses, Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence

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Part 1 of Witch's Apprentice AU

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by genVicron

Summary

There's something in the Whispering Woods, it screams at night, tears through fences, and hoards blue baubles.

Notes

Listened to Hayloft 2 and this popped fully formed into my brain, enjoy.

See the end of the work for more notes

There was a ghost in the Whispering Woods.

Move, just keep moving, she couldn't stop, couldn't think.

People said they could hear it screaming in the night.

Red moon, Black Garnet. Hate, *hate,* ***hate.***

The people of Thaymore had taken to leaving glass baubles on the outskirts of their village to appease it.

Her colours, Her eyes.

Once they had been in all the colours of the rainbow, but now only blue offerings littered the sides of the road.

"I'm sorry." No, no, *no.*

Some said it was actually a monster, a mess of fur, fangs and claws that stole livestock.

Hungry, so hungry.

They said it was completely wild, lashing out at any it laid eyes on without hesitation

Too close, too close, *leave.*

The shepherds built fences lined with red paint. It stopped taking livestock, but the fences never stood for long.

Lightning, She's screaming, you're *hurting Her.* Stop it, *stop it!*

Some said it was a girl, lost to the pull of the Whispering Woods.

Move, run, jump, claw and bite; brown and green and noisy and *alive.*

A red jacket appeared on the seamstress' doorstep. Synthetic cloth, Horde cloth, worn and ratty, the arms hanging by threads. A heap of blue glass and stones was piled atop it like payment.

Fix it, please, it's all she has left.

The spirit settled somewhat, once the jacket was repaired and left with the blue baubles.

She doesn’t have a name for the feeling, because she only ever felt it for Her.

Monsters wandered from the Woods less often.

It is her territory, Her eyes, Her coat around her shoulders again. This place gave them to her. *“I promise.”*

Still, none saw more than a glimpse, and none could say for certain whether it was a spirit, beast, or child.

Don’t look, stay away, she *can’t.*

Until the Horde came.

Gunmetal, walking things that have never been alive, the wings, the *red.*

“What are you doing? Get out.”

“You’re hurting her!”

The Ghost of the Woods swept out of the trees like a hurricane, claws and teeth and matted hair tore through the invaders, screaming like the end of the world.

"She will live. Leave us."

"Catra!"

"Stop it! You're killing her!"

She hadn't been strong enough before. She is different now, sharper, faster.

When it was over, the Beast of Thaymore perched atop a ruined tank, blood and oil dripping from its jaws and down its arms, its tail twitching back and forth.

"I'm sorry."

"Don't talk, please, hang on."

"Looks like I can't… keep our promise." Blue eyes- Her eyes- went dim, went glassy.

They can see her. It *itches.*

"Now look at what you've made me do." And she ***ran.***

The seamstress recognized the coat draped around her shoulders. Her eyes locked on the Lost Girl's mismatched orange and blue. She nodded, and the girl fled.

End Notes

Come say hi at Makuta's Chronicle or genVicron!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!